

7 Excel Formulas That Handle 90% of Real Work

Most people use 3. Power users live inside 7.

FORMULA 1 - XLOOKUP

Find anything in any direction

```
=XLOOKUP(lookup_value, search_range, return_range, "Not Found")
```

Replaces VLOOKUP and HLOOKUP. Searches any direction. Handles errors automatically. Learn this one first.

FORMULA 2 - SUMIFS

Sum with multiple conditions in one step

```
=SUMIFS(sum_range, criteria_range1, criteria1,  
criteria_range2, criteria2)
```

Stop building helper columns to filter before summing. SUMIFS does it inline. Same pattern for COUNTIFS, AVERAGEIFS, MINIFS, MAXIFS.

FORMULA 3 - IFERROR

Make your files look professional instantly

```
=IFERROR(your_formula, "No Result")
```

Wrap any formula in IFERROR. Errors become clean readable text. One habit that makes every file you build look intentional.

FORMULA 4 - TEXT

Format any value into any string

```
=TEXT(B2, "$#, ##0")
```

```
="Revenue as of "&TEXT(TODAY(), "MMMM YYYY")
```

Combine with & to build dynamic labels that update themselves every month, every quarter, every year.

FORMULA 5 - FILTER

Filter without filters

```
=FILTER(SalesData, SalesData[Region]="West")
```

Returns a live, filtered list. Updates instantly when source data changes. The biggest single upgrade to Excel formulas in 20 years.

FORMULA 6 - INDEX MATCH

The flexible lookup pair (still useful in 2026)

```
=INDEX(return_range, MATCH(lookup_value, search_range, 0))
```

XLOOKUP replaces this for new work - but you'll inherit thousands of legacy INDEX/MATCH formulas. Know how it works.

FORMULA 7 - LET

Name your variables inside a formula

```
=LET(rate, 0.08, qty, A2, price, B2, qty * price * (1+rate))
```

Long formulas become readable. Calculations get reused without repeating. The modern way to write complex formulas.

Which of these do you use every day?

Drop your answer. And share the formula not on this list
that you think belongs here.

Riley Stream